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(1) Research Program/Project/Study Title: Whispers of Resilience: LGBTQIA+ and Women's Lived Experiences of Gender Microaggressions in University Workplace	
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Program or Project has component (if no proceed to 2)? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Component Title:	
Component Leader:	
Academic Rank:	

(2) Category (please check) ☒ Social Science/Education /Humanities & other related fields ☐ Natural/Biological Sciences ☐ Food Research/ ☐ Developmental/ Computer/Engineering/ Architecture ☐ Extension ☐ Poster		(3) Research Center [Check the concerned center] ☒ SSITRDC Social Science and Industrial Technology Research Development Center ☐ LRDC Livestock Research Development Center ☐ FFRDC Fisheries and Food Research Development Center ☐ CSRDC Crop Science Research Development Center	
(4) Site of implementation			
		Municipality/City:	
		Province:	Capiz
		Region:	Region VI
(5) Classification Research: Development: ☐ Basic ☐ Pilot Testing ☒ Applied ☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization		(6) Mode of Implementation ☐ Single Authorship/Proponent ☒ Collaborative Research (within campus) ☐ Collaborative Research (intercampus) ☐ Collaborative Research (external agency)	
(7) Sector/Commodity Education		(8) Discipline/Field of Specialization Management/Education Mathematics/English	

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(9) Rationale

In a complex workplace like Higher Education Institutions, disagreements may be considered normal and disruptive behavior, including gender microaggressions, may be tolerated and allowed to persist (Rodriguez, 2019). Gender microaggressions, characterized as subtle yet detrimental (Balters, et. al., 2023), everyday putdowns, slights, or remarks directed at a specific gender, represent a widely experienced yet inadequately studied phenomenon (Dochania, 2024; Lui & Quezada, 2019). While existing literature explores gender microaggressions in the medical field (Lee, et al., 2023, Balters, et al., 2023), a significant gap exists in comprehending the experiences of women and LGBTQIA+ groups within university workplaces.

The term "microaggression" was initially introduced by Pierce in 1977 and later redefined by Sue et al. in 2007 to encompass not only race but also gender and sexual orientation. Microaggressions are everyday acts that are subtle in nature, intentional or unintentional, that negatively impact a target group or person due to their hostile or derogatory nature (Sue, Bucceri, Lin, Nadal, & Torino, 2007). In the Philippines, legislative initiatives like the Anti-Violence Against Women and Their Children Act of 2004 (Republic Act 9262), the Gender-Based Sexual Harassment Act (Republic Act No. 11313), and the Magna Carta of Women (Republic Act 9710) reflect a commitment to eliminating discrimination. While these laws target overt discrimination, subtler forms persist without legal repercussions, empowering perpetrators and often escaping the attention of organizations. Gender microaggressions, representing a subtle manifestation of sexism, have emerged as a prevalent and challenging-to-detect prejudice affecting various minority groups, including women, racial minorities, and LGBTQIA+ individuals. Despite legal frameworks, women and members of the LGBTQIA+ community remain targets of microaggressions, gender-biased language, and gender stereotyping (Rodriguez, 2019). While explicit harassment and issues of consent influence campus culture, microaggressions contribute to a broader culture that normalizes harassment and gender-based violence (Rodriguez, 2019). Microaggressions serve as tools that subtly normalize acts of violence. This situation necessitates complete understanding about the nuances of contemporary discrimination and comprehending the enduring nature of modern workplace sexism (Kim & Meister, 2022).

Microaggressions have deleterious effects which manifest in internalized emotions like guilt, resentment, and anger, while also negatively impacting relationships (Nadal, 2013). The impacts on mental and physiological well-being of these subtle discriminatory behaviors manifest in neural activity (Balters et al., 2023) which linked to burnout, heightened depression, anxiety, and stress (Lee et al., 2023). Aligning to the Sustainable Development Goal #5 addressing gender equality, this research seeks to discover the specific experiences of LGBTQIA+ individuals and women facing gender microaggressions in university workplaces which intends to provide insights for fostering inclusive, supportive, and professional environments.

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(9-A) Project Description

This project aims to explore and understand the lived experiences of LGBTQIA+ and women employees in the university workplace regarding gender microaggressions. The complexities of gender microaggression experiences will be used to understand how modern sexism exist, thereby fostering an inclusive environment for all. Policies could be developed, institutional strategies may be implemented, and collaboration with stakeholders may happen to ensure that this investigation will serve its practical, ethical, and other purposes.

(10) Objectives/Statement of the Problem

The university workplace often serves as a microculture of societal dynamics and a grounding place of practices and behavior where individuals belonging to the LGBTQIA+ community and women navigate through subtle yet impactful gender microaggressions. The persistence of these microaggressions poses a significant challenge to the well-being and professional experiences of these individuals which requires a comprehensive investigation to understand the depth and nuances of their lived experiences.

Specifically, this study aims to answer the following questions.

1. What are LGBTQIA+ individuals and women's experiences of gender microaggressions in university workplace?
2. How are LGBTQIA+ individuals and women affected by gender microaggressions in the university workplace?
3. What are the response mechanisms and coping strategies employed by LGBTQIA+ individuals and women in the face of gender microaggressions in the university workplace?

(11) Review of Literature/Prior Art Search (Related researchers/activities that have been conducted. State-of –the-art of current technology / information from which the project proposal will take-off).

Gender Microaggression in Modern Workplace

Gender microaggressions refer to brief, often unintentional, and regularly encountered verbal, behavioral, or environmental indignities that convey hostile, derogatory, or negative slights toward women (Nadal, 2008; Sue et al., 2008). Despite their subtlety, these microaggressions derogate the target, indicating exclusion and a sense of not belonging (Wilkins-Yel et al., 2019). Compared to existing work on gender discrimination, such as modern sexism or incivility (Cortina, 2008; Swim et al., 1995), microaggressions concentrate more on interpersonal behaviors than general attitudes. Microaggressions can be categorized into three types—microassault, microinsult, and microinvalidation—based on their subtlety levels (Nadal, 2010; Sue et al., 2008). Microassaults are explicit demeaning comments or behaviors towards

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women. Microassaults are unintentional denigrations which are conveyed in messages favoring male in conversations. Microinvalidation negates other gender's experiences invalidating their experiences and lived realities.

Gender microaggressions is different from sex-based harassment in a way that microaggression de-emphasizes intent and focuses on victim's perspective without protecting the dominating party (Berdahl, 2007; Cortina & Berdahl, 2008; Capodilupo et al., 2010). There are cases when the aggressors are unaware of their microaggressions (Capodilupo et al., 2010; Nadal, 2010) complicating the intervention efforts that would challenge individual's self-perception and self-esteem (Wiesenfeld et al., 1999). There is a growing body of works claiming that gender microaggressions occur in workplaces (Gartner et al., 2020; Yang & Carroll, 2018), however there are a few which focus on LGBTQAI+ individuals and women working in university. Thus, this study aims to highlight the gender microaggressions experienced by these vulnerable groups and discover how they make sense of their experiences in an effort to promote diverse training efforts in university workplaces.

Microaggressions Toward Lesbian Women, Gay Men, And Bisexual People

The microaggression framework of Sue et al. (2007) and Sue and Capodilupo (2008) acknowledge the existence of gender microaggression on the interpersonal and systemic levels in various settings, including the government and educational systems (Wong et al. 2011).

Nadal, Issa, and colleagues (2011) found that lesbians encounter microaggressions rooted in misogyny. Platt and Lenzen (2013) identified the theme of undersexualization experienced by lesbians, often assuming their sexual orientation is a phase. Gay men face derisive language, policing of masculinity, and stereotyping. Bisexual individuals endure stereotypes and questioning of their sexual authenticity. Genderqueer individuals commonly face microaggressions related to the presumption of the gender binary and incorrect gender pronoun use (Shulz, 2012; Testa et al., 2015). While gender microaggressions in the medical field are explored, a significant gap exists in understanding the experiences of women and LGBTQIA+ + groups within university workplaces.

Consequences of Microaggressions Against Women and LGBTQIA+ +

According to Sands (1998), women and adolescent girls may be more prone to experiencing depression, low self-esteem, and feelings of helplessness and passivity when strict adherence to gender norms is implied or expected, perpetuated through gender microaggressions. Additionally, Nadal and Haynes (2012) highlighted that negative messages regarding gender stereotypes, conveyed through societal, social, and familial relationships, can result in diminished academic and career self-concepts for girls and members of the LGBTQIA+ + community. This effect manifests in internalized emotions such as guilt, resentment, and anger, while also adversely affecting relationships (Nadal, 2013).

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While microaggressions are often fleeting and everyday occurrences (Periyakoil et al., 2020), characterized by unintentional indignities and insults (Sue, 2010), their consequences for the receiver can be substantial. Empirical studies demonstrate that gender-based microaggressions not only impact immediate performance outcomes, such as in math tasks (referred to as "stereotype threat" by Spencer et al., 1999) but also have broader implications. The victims of gender microaggression might feel decreasing satisfaction on their job (Chan et al., 2008) and commitment to their work (Foley et al., 2005), which may also hinder their career advancement (Fassiotto et al., 2016; Herrbach & Mignonac, 2012), and affect their self-esteem (Casad et al., 2019) and income negatively (National Academies of Sciences et al., 2017). The worst case may potentially trigger the employee to leave their workplace (Kim & Meister, 2022) due to social exclusion (Cogoni et al., 2018; Zhang et al., 2021) and recurrence of triggers of self-doubt. An increased levels of distress (Chan et al., 2008) leading to depression and anxiety are also considered as health consequences of the microaggression experience (Feigt et al., 2022; Nadal et al., 2013), which are experienced oftentimes by women of color and those with disabilities (Olkin et al., 2019; Wilkins-Yel et al., 2019). Balters et al. (2023) have shown neural reactivity representing the impact on mental and physiological well-being. If not given attention, the perennial problem about gender disparities will continue to persist and affect people that serves as the backbone of any organization.

(12) Scientific Basis/Theoretical Framework (Include concepts, theories and variables that indicate relevant relationships to be tested.

The epistemological foundation of constructivism and the theoretical perspective of interpretivism provide the framework for this study. Interpretivism involves understanding something within its context, acknowledging that individuals may respond to a stimulus in various ways due to the context-bound nature of their actions, which depends on factors such as time, location, and the people involved. That is, people create and associate their own subjective meanings as they interact with the world around them (Holloway, 1997). Therefore, interpretive research aims to comprehend phenomena by evaluating the meanings that key informants attribute to them.

The foundation of this study also rests on genderlect theory, asserting that the communication styles of women and men differ which gives rise to a distinctive dialect influenced by their individual language usage. Using this lens is viewing that men and women came from different subcultures and, therefore, may affect their linguistic behaviors (Tenorio, 2016). As proposed by Deborah Tannen in 1990, there is a disparity on communication between men and women which may lead to challenges, such as miscommunication, misunderstanding, and other university conflicts.

To understand the complexities of gender microaggressions existing in university workplace, the study will take the organizational culture theory in viewing and interpreting the values and practices of the organization forming the culture and behavior of employees (Saad & Kaur, 2020). The sense of belongingness of an employee stem from the culture of the organization and the institutional environment

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that either promote or hinder inclusion and support. The norms and values which may have contributed to gender microaggressions experiences will be explored, as well as power dynamics, leadership, and communication patterns. These factors of organizational culture will be taken into consideration to comprehensively understand the gender microaggression as the narratives unfold.

(13) Methodology

Research Design

Phenomenological research, according to Creswell (2003), is a qualitative approach where the researcher seeks to uncover the essence of human experiences related to a specific phenomenon. In this context, the focus is on delving into lived experiences to gain profound insights into how individuals perceive and understand those experiences. This particular study will adopt transcendental phenomenology, as outlined by Creswell and Poth (2018). The choice of this approach is driven by the intention to minimize the researcher's interpretations and prioritize a descriptive account of the participants' experiences. Furthermore, Moustakas emphasizes one of Husserl's concepts, known as epoche or bracketing. This involves investigators temporarily setting aside their own experiences to approach the phenomenon under examination with a fresh perspective. In essence, the term "transcendental" implies perceiving everything as if encountering it for the first time. This research design aims to explore the richness and depth inherent in participants' encounters with gender microaggressions. Through the application of this qualitative research design, the study seeks to address existing research gaps, particularly in the underexplored experiences of LGBTQIA+ individuals and women in the university workplace.

Participants

The participants in this study must (1) be employees of a state university in Capiz, (2) have at least one (1) year of work experience, (3) self-identify as either a woman or a member of the LGBTQIA+ community, and (4) voluntarily agree to participate in the study.

Data Sources

The study will gather data using Work-related Demographics sheets and Interview Guide.

Work-related Demographics. To better understand the participants of this study, work-related demographics will be gathered. An accompanying work-related demographic data sheet will be used to gather information on the participants' characteristics such as age, sex, religious affiliation, marital status, educational qualifications, designation, employment status, and the number of years in service as a university employee.

Interview Guide. An interview guide will be employed to inquire about microaggressions from the participants. Given the sensitivity and confidentiality of the

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topic of gender aggression, individual interviews are appropriate for this research. Probing techniques will be utilized during the interviews. The researchers will delve into all aspects of gender microaggression until redundancy or saturation is achieved, covering all pertinent topics related to gender microaggression in the university workplace.

Data Collection Procedure

Permission to conduct the study will be requested from the University President to enable the research to be carried out university-wide. The researchers will seek connections through the HR Office of each campus and satellite college to disseminate the call for participants through a google form. Those who are qualified and volunteer will be interviewed. Interviews may be conducted either face-to-face or online, recorded for video documentation, and will be subsequently transcribed verbatim. The entire interview will be conversational.

Ethical Considerations. Approval for ethical conduct will be sought from the University's Ethics Review Committee, if established. To uphold confidentiality, the transcripts will exclude any personal or identifying information. Pseudonyms will be assigned to interview participants to safeguard their real identities. Acknowledging the potential risk of psychological distress resulting from recalling incidents of workplace violence, the researchers will seek assistance from experts experienced in debriefing and knowledgeable about referral services for ongoing psychological distress. Contact numbers of these experts will be provided in the cover letter, inviting participants to reach out and discuss any psychological distress arising from the interview.

Data Analysis

The inductive data analysis will be used for this transcendental phenomenological study to generate themes and gradual categorization of data. Moustaka's (1994) stepwise data analysis by Greenings (2019) will be followed. Preconceived beliefs and opinions about the gender microaggression experiences of the LGBTQIA+ and women employees will be identified (phenomenological reduction). This is followed by bracketing out process focusing on the understanding of gender microaggression based on prior studies. The researchers will present variations of data repeatedly until consensus is reached. Next to this is analysis of data which include categorization and making sense of significant meanings embedded in the microaggression experiences by the study participants.

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(15) Expected Output (Indicate the specific products, processes or services which the project is expected to produce; quantify when possible)

Publication- 1 publishable journal article

Patent/Intellectual Property-

Product-

People Services- Comprehensive training modules on gender microaggressions in university workplaces tailored for both LGBTQIA+ + and women employees

Partnership- Collaborative partnerships with universities and organizations focusing on workplace diversity and inclusion

Policy- Recommendations for inclusive workplace policies addressing gender microaggressions

Social Impact

An inclusive, respectful, and professional university workplace environment would be created if incidences of gender microaggressions will be acknowledged and victims will not be left behind. A productive workplace will be promoted if equality and mutual respect are established.

Economic Impact

A professional workplace can retain and attract talents which will lead to increased productivity, employee satisfaction, innovation, and even transformation for development.

(16) Technology Transfer Activity Design (Indicate the specific products, activity design, processes or services to be transferred as extension activities)

(17) Target Beneficiaries (Who the clienteles are and what are the expected outcome/effects of the use of the projects output)

LGBTQIA+ and Women University Employees. Higher education, with employees of diverse personalities, may tolerate gender microaggression among employees. This study acknowledges that there are LGBTQIA+ and women employees in university workplaces who are experiencing these subtle defamations. Acknowledging these detrimental incidents is giving voices to victims by not confining themselves to the culture of silence. This work may serve as basis for forming strategies that decrease the occurrence of this experience. Irrespective of sexual orientation, each employee deserves to stay in environment which fosters respect, promotes inclusivity, and giving priority to the well-being of employees.

Men Employees. The study aims to make male employees be aware of the gender microaggression by giving them insights of the effects of untoward incidents which involves them. Intentional or not, they have a role to play in creating a more inclusive environment for all.

University Administrators and Leaders. Affecting the entire system is the behavior of the people forming the backbone of the organization. This may give them ideas to conduct organizational assessment which may lead to formulation of policies, guidelines, or strategies to reinforce desirable behavior expected from professionals in the field. The goal is to prevent the existence of the gender microaggression incident and cultivate a more inclusive work environment.

Commission on Higher Education (CHED). The Commission on Higher Education (CHED) may be made aware about gender microaggression and its effect to employees. Policy change may be done to prevent gender microaggression that affect the system of education which may put the welfare of employees and their students at stake. Recommendations concerning the LGBTQAI+ and women employees may be integrated to crate respectful environment within the academe.

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Philippine Commission on Women (PSW). The PCW may be informed about the findings to update programs and even create programs catering the women and LGBTQIA+ employees. Advocacies addressing the need for awareness and interventions for gender microaggressions may be created.

(18) Personnel Requirement

Name	Role (Program, Project, Study Leader)	Field of Specialization
Leizyl B. Igdanes	Study Leader	Mathematics
Alita Rose B. Candare	Member	English
Jee Marie Zaragoza	Member	Business Management
R-Jun Frederick A. Gaspe	Member	Animal Science

Percent time devoted to the Program/ Project/ Study

Program/Project Leader (in hours): 5 hours/week

Program/Project Members (in hours):

(19) Budgetary Requirement

SOURCES OF EXPENSES	Quantity	Amount (PhP)
A. Personnel Services (For studies needed the Research Assistant, informant/s, guide)	2	P 30, 000.00
B. Maintenance and Other Operating Expenses (MOOE) (modify and include only whichever is applicable)		
- Transportation allowance	4	P20,000.00
- Meal allowance during data gathering		P40,000.00
- Professional fees (laboratory analysis and other related fees)		
- Miscellaneous (for incidental expenses)		P5, 000.00
- Printing		P5, 000.00
C. CAPITAL OUTLAY		P50,000.00
Total		P150,000.00

(20) Literature Cited (include only those references published in reputable journals, and at least that from CAPSU Research Journal, <http://researchjournal.capsu.edu.ph/>)

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(21) Capsule Curriculum Vitae (One-page brief C.V. only)

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